

Comparison Matrix

Side-by-Side Quick-Drill – All 12 Channels, Cumulative

Isolated facts about one channel are 30 disconnected trivia items. Facts placed next to a channel's neighbors become pattern recognition. This document groups the 12 primary channels into the 4 sets that share hand/foot + Yin/Yang category -- one channel from each of the 3 circuits -- plus a compact paired-channel table.

This Document Contains:

Hand-Yin Triad: LU vs PC vs HT

Hand-Yang Triad: LI vs SJ vs SI

Foot-Yang Triad: ST vs GB vs BL

Foot-Yin Triad: SP vs LR vs KI (incl. the SP/LR crossing-point trap)

Compact paired-channel table -- all 6 pairs, one page

Core attributes verified via existing Master Comparison (Wk1-6)

Limb-position + direction rows are standard CAM/Deadman topography,
labeled as general reference rather than lecture-specific claims.

Jonathan Centeno · D.AcHM Candidate · VUIM Summer 2026

All three: chest -> hand, arm midline positions

	LU	PC	HT
Yin/Yang	Yin	Yin	Yin
Hand/Foot	Hand	Hand	Hand
Element	Metal	Fire (Min.)	Fire
Direction	Chest -> Hand	Chest -> Hand	Chest -> Hand
Limb position	Anterior/radial line, arm	Middle line, arm	Posterior/ulnar line, arm
Pair	LI	SJ	SI
# Points	11	9	9
Pertains	Lung	Pericardium	Heart
Connects	Lg Intestine	San Jiao	Sm Intestine
Yuan-Source	LU9	PC7	HT7
Luo-Connecting	LU7	PC6	HT5
Xi-Cleft	LU6	PC4	HT6
He-Sea	LU5	PC3	HT3
Front-Mu	LU1	CV17	CV14
Back-Shu	BL13	BL14	BL15
Confluent (8EV)	LU7 (Ren Mai)	PC6 (Yin Wei)	--

Distinguishing features:

- **LU:** 1st to receive Qi from food/air (Tai Yin opens); only channel with no crossing points listed
- **PC:** Zero crossing points (same trap pattern as HT); pathway is the shortest of the 3
- **HT:** Zero crossing points (same trap pattern as PC); the only Fire (proper) Yin channel

All three: hand -> head, arm midline positions

	LI	SJ	SI
Yin/Yang	Yang	Yang	Yang
Hand/Foot	Hand	Hand	Hand
Element	Metal	Fire (Min.)	Fire
Direction	Hand -> Head	Hand -> Head	Hand -> Head
Limb position	Anterior/radial line, arm	Middle line, arm	Posterior/ulnar line, arm
Pair	LU	PC	HT
# Points	20	23	19
Pertains	Lg Intestine	San Jiao	Sm Intestine
Connects	Lung	Pericardium	Heart
Yuan-Source	LI4	SJ4	SI4
Luo-Connecting	LI6	SJ5	SI7
Xi-Cleft	LI7	SJ7	SI6
He-Sea	LI11	SJ10	SI8
Front-Mu	ST25	CV5	CV4
Back-Shu	BL25	BL22	BL27
Confluent (8EV)	--	SJ5 (Yang Wei)	SI3 (Du Mai)

Distinguishing features:

- LI: Zero incoming meeting points; ends beside the nose, handing off to ST -- classic trap
- SJ: Extensive GB overlap (both Shaoyang) -- crosses GB twice at the shoulder
- SI: Longest hand-Yang pathway; scapula zigzag before reaching the face

All three: head -> foot, leg midline positions

	ST	GB	BL
Yin/Yang	Yang	Yang	Yang
Hand/Foot	Foot	Foot	Foot
Element	Earth	Wood	Water
Direction	Head -> Foot	Head -> Foot	Head -> Foot
Limb position	Anterior line, leg	Lateral/middle line, leg	Posterior line, leg
Pair	SP	LR	KI
# Points	45	44	67
Pertains	Stomach	Gallbladder	Bladder
Connects	Spleen	Liver	Kidney
Yuan-Source	ST42	GB40	BL64
Luo-Connecting	ST40	GB37	BL58
Xi-Cleft	ST34	GB36	BL63
He-Sea	ST36	GB34	BL40
Front-Mu	CV12	GB24	CV3
Back-Shu	BL21	BL19	BL28
Confluent (8EV)	--	GB41 (Dai Mai)	BL62 (Yang Qiao)

Distinguishing features:

- ST: Only channel through the nipple; longest primary channel by point count (45)
- GB: Most zigzagging head pathway of any channel; GB34 = He-Sea + Hui-Meeting of Sinews
- BL: Most points of any channel (67); carries all 12 Back-Shu points

All three: foot -> chest/abdomen, medial leg

	SP	LR	KI
Yin/Yang	Yin	Yin	Yin
Hand/Foot	Foot	Foot	Foot
Element	Earth	Wood	Water
Direction	Foot -> Chest/Abdomen	Foot -> Chest/Abdomen	Foot -> Chest/Abdomen
Limb position	Medial leg	Medial leg	Medial leg
Pair	ST	GB	BL
# Points	21	14	27
Pertains	Spleen	Liver	Kidney
Connects	Stomach	Gallbladder	Bladder
Yuan-Source	SP3	LR3	KI3
Luo-Connecting	SP4	LR5	KI4
Xi-Cleft	SP8	LR6	KI5
He-Sea	SP9	LR8	KI10
Front-Mu	LR13	LR14	GB25
Back-Shu	BL20	BL18	BL23
Confluent (8EV)	SP4 (Chong Mai)	--	KI6 (Yin Qiao)

Distinguishing features:

- SP: Only channel with a distribution exception -- crosses in front of LR above 8 cun from medial malleolus
- LR: Reaches the vertex (GV20) via its final branch; LR13 = Front-Mu of SP + Hui-Meeting of Zang (2 categories)
- KI: Only medial-leg channel with NO crossing exception -- posterior line throughout

Pair	Element	Yin ch.	Yang ch.	Yin Yuan	Yang Yuan	Yin Luo	Yang Luo	Confluent link
LU-LI	Metal	LU	LI	LU9	LI4	LU7	LI6	LU7 (Ren Mai)
ST-SP	Earth	ST	SP	ST42	SP3	ST40	SP4	SP4 (Chong Mai)
HT-SI	Fire	HT	SI	HT7	SI4	HT5	SI7	SI3 (Du Mai)
BL-KI	Water	BL	KI	BL64	KI3	BL58	KI4	BL62 (Yang Qiao) / KI6 (Yin Qiao)
PC-SJ	Fire (Min.)	PC	SJ	PC7	SJ4	PC6	SJ5	PC6 (Yin Wei) / SJ5 (Yang Wei)
GB-LR	Wood	GB	LR	GB40	LR3	GB37	LR5	GB41 (Dai Mai)

Note: 'Confluent link' lists every confluent point taught in the pair. PC-SJ and GB-LR each contribute two (different Extraordinary Vessels). LU-LI, ST-SP, HT-SI, BL-KI each contribute one, from only one member of the pair.